

Hand-lettering *the inscription.*

A brief for Jill: writing the master for Much Ado About One Side in your own copperplate

*Come, palindove, let edges twine;
thy side is mine, and mine is thine.*

01 Overview

The poem, written once in your own copperplate at its most beautiful. We scan it, adapt it for the laser, and wrap it around the sculpture.

02 Step by step

Ten steps. Most of the time is your usual warm-up and writing; the rest is checking words and getting a clean scan.

03 Templates

Copperplate guide sheets with each row's words printed above its lines, a style-sample sheet, a hard-words sheet, blank sheets, and a plain baseline sheet if you prefer fewer lines.

04 The easy parts

If you only read one page, read this one. The five essentials, the suggested sizes, the row checklist, and what to send back.

05 In depth

Proportions, spacing and joins, flourish room, what the laser can hold and how the adaptation gets your hairlines there, materials in detail, the scan-to-foil pipeline, and troubleshooting.

23 master rows in your own copperplate · x-height about 7 mm · hairlines thickened after the scan · print every template sheet at 100 % and check its 100 mm bar.

The rendered script in this guide is the substitute font Great Vibes (SIL Open Font License), shown for size and spacing only. Project text and artwork: MIT OR Apache-2.0. muchadoaboutoneside.com/calligraphy

Overview

The poem, written once in your own copperplate at its most beautiful. We scan it, adapt it for the laser, and wrap it around the sculpture.

The sculpture is a figure-eight snake wrapped in aluminum foil. The poem “Much Ado About One Side” is laser-marked onto that foil as one continuous ribbon of script that runs along the body, around the nose, back along the other side, around the tail, and straight into its own first word. The website currently shows the poem in a substitute font. Your hand replaces it.

This is not a job of writing to a specification. Write the poem the way you would write it for someone you love: pointed pen, hairlines and shades, your loops, your capitals, your flourishes. What we need from the sheets is only what a computer cannot recover afterwards, and there are five such things.

- 01

The exact words
Every letter and punctuation mark as printed on the exact-text page, one labelled row at a time, compound words unbroken.

- 02

Black on white
Dark black ink on smooth, bright white paper. Any pen you love, as long as its thinnest line is a solid line and not a scratch.

- 03

One row per label
Each row ID gets exactly one finished row. Never split a word between rows; if a row runs long, stop at a word gap and continue on the next row as part b.

- 04

Rows that stay apart
Flourish as freely as you like inside a row, but keep rows from touching each other. The sheets leave 56 mm between baselines for that.

- 05

A good scan
Flatbed, 1200 dpi if the scanner allows and 600 dpi otherwise, greyscale, no automatic enhancement, with the row labels and the 100 mm bar in frame.

What happens after you hand the sheets over

Your rows are scanned and traced into vector outlines. Copperplate hairlines are far thinner than a laser can mark on foil, so every hairline is thickened to a floor the machine can hold, while your shaded strokes keep their weight and shape. Rows are normalised to one x-height, joined into the ribbon with even word gaps, and scaled to each edition. Small repairs are made digitally, with your originals beside the screen, and nothing is invented. You approve a proof before any foil is marked.

WHO DOES WHAT

YOU	AFTER THE SCAN
Write in your own copperplate: hairline upstrokes, shaded downstrokes, your loops and flourishes.	Every hairline is thickened to a floor the laser can mark; your shades and shapes stay as written.
Write at the size that is comfortable, anywhere from 6 to 10 mm x-height, the same on every row.	Rows are measured from their guide lines and normalised to one common x-height.
Use your natural slant. The sheets carry a 55° guide because that is the copperplate standard; a few degrees either way is fine.	Nothing is done to slant. It is part of your hand.
Space words as you usually do and end each row after its final punctuation.	Word gaps are evened, the double gap between poem lines is inserted, and the rows are joined into one continuous ribbon.
Let flourishes run as long as the row allows, within the dotted ceiling and floor.	A flourish that would collide with a neighbouring row on the sculpture is trimmed slightly or the rows are re-spaced; you see it on the proof.
Rewrite a row you dislike rather than patching it.	Small repairs (a broken hairline, a blot, a stray dot) are cleaned up digitally, with your originals as the reference; no letter is ever invented.

The ribbon has no end. The final ellipsis after “twine...” runs straight into the opening “Come,”. Shown in the substitute font at about maquette size.

ends with “twine...” begins with “Come,”

One complete poem in the substitute font · 2.5 mm em here, 2.5 mm on the maquette

Where the lettering goes

EDITION	SIZE OF THE LETTERING	HOW THE POEM REPEATS
180 mm printed maquette (first physical run)	2.5 mm em, x-height about 0.89 mm	2 complete repetitions along one 1028 mm ribbon around the body
Full-size sculpture (conceptual study)	Set after fit tests; the same outlines scale up	4 rows around the body, each one complete poem on a closed reading path; the jaw carries its own 18-row inscription

Your hand, not the font

Great Vibes was chosen as a placeholder because its slant and flourished capitals came closest to your sample. It appears in this guide only where a size comparison needs it. Nothing about it is a target.

The poem, exactly

01 Come, palindove, let edges twine;
02 thy side is mine, and mine is thine.

03 Draw, O coward! cries the knight.
04 So inkhands draw him at halfheight.
05 That halfknight draws a quarterknight,
06 who draws a knightling, out of sight.
07 This swordfeud, quoth one, is accursed:
08 each little inkprick's like the first!
09 Take sides! they roar. The turncoat sighs:
10 I have but one. Do thou likewise.

11 Split it, then! Slit it lengthwise through:
12 it comes round doublelong, not two.
13 Then who's our foe? Thy mirrorknave.
14 Look edgewise: that's thine own swordwave.

15 Onesided! End it! The strip shrugs: Fine.
16 Tail dovetails head; mine's thine, thine's mine:
17 come, palindove, let edges twine...

❧ THE ELLIPSIS RUNS STRAIGHT INTO LINE 01

Step by step

Ten steps. Most of the time is your usual warm-up and writing; the rest is checking words and getting a clean scan.

01 Read the poem aloud from the exact-text page

Note the invented compound words (palindove, inkhands, halfheight, halfknight, quarterknight, knightling, swordfeud, doublelong, mirrorknave, swordwave), the five apostrophes, the single ellipsis, and the lowercase "come" that opens the last line. The wording is checked letter by letter against the source text.

CHECK You can find every mark on the punctuation inventory without looking twice.

02 Set up as you always do

Your nib, holder, black ink, and the paper you trust. Print the master sheets at 100 % and use them under your paper on a light pad, or print them straight onto the writing paper. The materials table has suggestions only if you want them.

CHECK The 100 mm bar on a printed sheet measures 100 mm, within 1 mm.

03 Warm up on the style-sample sheet

A row of joined lowercase and two rows of capitals with your favourite flourishes, at the size you will use for the poem. This sheet is also a reference for the adaptation: if a letter ever needs repair, it is matched to your own alphabet.

CHECK The rows are written at one consistent size you can keep for 23 rows.

04 Practise the hard words

The hard-words sheet lists the compound words. Write each as one word with no gap and no hyphen. The poem's capitals are C, D, E, F, I, L, O, S, T; try the flourishes you intend for each.

CHECK Every flourish stays between the dotted ceiling and floor lines.

05 Write the master rows in order

Each master sheet shows three rows, each with its row ID and its words printed in small type above the guide lines. Write the row on the baseline below its words. If a row runs long, stop at a word gap and continue on the next row, labelling both with the same ID plus a and b (a spare row is ruled on the last sheet, and blank sheets are included).

CHECK Every row begins at the left rule, ends before the right margin, and matches its printed words.

06 Let every sheet dry fully

Sumi and pigment inks are touch dry in minutes and safe to handle in an hour. Do not stack sheets or erase before then.

CHECK A clean tissue pressed on the darkest shade picks up nothing.

07 Review the words, not the beauty

Check each row against the exact-text page with a finger under every word: spelling, capitals, punctuation, nothing added. Beauty you already judged as you wrote; if a row displeases you, that is a rewrite, not a repair.

CHECK Each row has a pencil tick in its label box.

08 Rewrite, do not patch

For a wrong letter, a blot, or a row you simply do not like, write the whole row again on a blank sheet with the same ID. Put a single pencil X through the rejected row and keep it; it is still useful reference.

CHECK Exactly one un-crossed row exists for each row ID.

09 Scan every sheet

Flatbed at 1200 dpi if the scanner allows, otherwise 600 dpi. Greyscale, no auto-contrast or sharpening, TIFF or PNG, one file per sheet named by sheet number. Keep the whole sheet in the scan, including the row labels and the 100 mm bar. If a scanner is impossible, photograph in even daylight, straight on, whole sheet in frame, and keep the originals safe for a proper scan later.

CHECK The scanned bar measures 100 mm when the file is opened at its stated resolution.

10 Approve the proof

Andrew sends back the adapted ribbon at 1:1 and 4:1 alongside a maquette-size print, with notes on anything that was thickened, re-spaced, or repaired. Mark what you want changed. Nothing is laser-marked before you approve, and the first laser job is a small test coupon, not the full skin.

CHECK You have written “approved” and the date on the proof.

Keep the originals

Please keep the paper sheets flat and unsigned until the proof is approved. A signature or note can be added afterwards on a separate sheet if you would like it recorded with the archive.

Templates

Copperplate guide sheets with each row's words printed above its lines, a style-sample sheet, a hard-words sheet, blank sheets, and a plain baseline sheet if you prefer fewer lines.

Every sheet is US Letter, landscape, with a 100 mm check bar in the header. On the copperplate sheets the solid lines are the baseline and x-height; dashes mark the ascender and descender lines at $1.5 \times$ x-height; dotted lines are the flourish ceiling and floor; faint diagonals show the 55° slant every 20 mm. The plain sheet keeps only the baseline and a faint x-height.

The 23 rows in poem order, three per sheet. Six long lines are written as two rows (a and b) and rejoined digitally.

SHEET 1

- R01** Come, palindove, let
edges twine;
- R02** thy side is mine, and mine
is thine.
- R03** Draw, O coward! cries the
knight.

SHEET 2

- R04** So inkhands draw him at
halfheight.
- R05** That halfknight draws a
quarterknight,
- R06** who draws a knightling,
out of sight.

SHEET 3

- R07** This swordfeud, quoth
one, is accursed:
- R08** each little inkprick's like
the first!
- R09a** Take sides! they roar.

SHEET 4

- R09b** The turncoat sighs:
- R10** I have but one. Do thou
likewise.
- R11a** Split it, then!

SHEET 5

- R11b** Slit it lengthwise through:
- R12** it comes round
doublelong, not two.
- R13a** Then who's our foe?

SHEET 6

- R13b** Thy mirrorknave.
- R14a** Look edgewise:
- R14b** that's thine own
swordwave.

SHEET 7

- R15a** Onesided! End it!
- R15b** The strip shrugs: Fine.
- R16a** Tail dovetails head;

SHEET 8

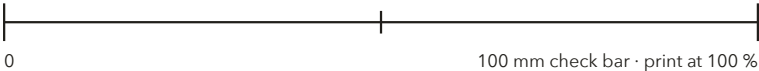
- R16b** mine's thine, thine's mine:
- R17** come, palindove, let
edges twine...

TOTAL

23 rows
on 8 sheets · writing width 235 mm

MUCH ADO ABOUT ONE SIDE • MASTER SHEET 1 OF 8

Rows R01 to R03 · write each row on the baseline beneath its printed words



R01

R01 · Come, palindove, let edges twine;

flourish ceiling +24

ascender · capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

descender -10.5

flourish floor -18

R02

R02 · thy side is mine, and mine is thine.

flourish ceiling +24

ascender · capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

descender -10.5

flourish floor -18

R03

R03 · Draw, O coward! cries the knight.

flourish ceiling +24

ascender · capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

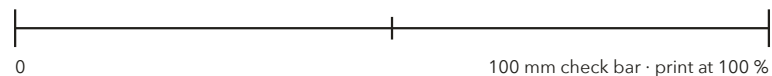
descender -10.5

flourish floor -18

Solid: baseline and x-height. Dashed: ascender and descender at 1.5 × x-height. Dotted: flourish ceiling and floor. Faint diagonals: 55° slant. A row without printed words is a spare for a part-b continuation.

MUCH ADO ABOUT ONE SIDE • MASTER SHEET 2 OF 8

Rows R04 to R06 · write each row on the baseline beneath its printed words



R04 · So inkhands draw him at halfheight.

R04

flourish ceiling +24

ascender / capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

descender -10.5

flourish floor -18

R05 · That halfknight draws a quarterknight,

R05

flourish ceiling +24

ascender / capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

descender -10.5

flourish floor -18

R06 · who draws a knightling, out of sight.

R06

flourish ceiling +24

ascender / capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

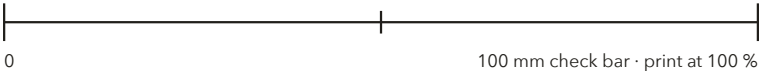
descender -10.5

flourish floor -18

Solid: baseline and x-height. Dashed: ascender and descender at $1.5 \times$ x-height. Dotted: flourish ceiling and floor. Faint diagonals: 55° slant. A row without printed words is a spare for a part-b continuation.

MUCH ADO ABOUT ONE SIDE • MASTER SHEET 3 OF 8

Rows R07 to R09a • write each row on the baseline beneath its printed words



R07

R07 • This swordfeud, quoth one, is accursed:

flourish ceiling +24

ascender • capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

descender -10.5

flourish floor -18

R08

R08 • each little inkprick's like the first!

flourish ceiling +24

ascender • capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

descender -10.5

flourish floor -18

R09a

R09a • Take sides! they roar.

flourish ceiling +24

ascender • capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

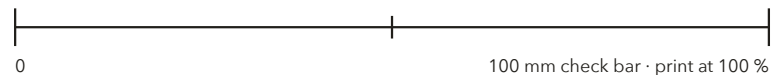
descender -10.5

flourish floor -18

Solid: baseline and x-height. Dashed: ascender and descender at 1.5 × x-height. Dotted: flourish ceiling and floor. Faint diagonals: 55° slant. A row without printed words is a spare for a part-b continuation.

MUCH ADO ABOUT ONE SIDE • MASTER SHEET 4 OF 8

Rows R09b to R11a · write each row on the baseline beneath its printed words



R09b · The turncoat sighs:

R09b

flourish ceiling +24

ascender / capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

descender -10.5

flourish floor –18

R10 · I have but one. Do thou likewise.

R10

flourish ceiling +24

ascender / capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

descender -10.5

flourish floor –18

R11a · Split it, then!

R11a

flourish ceiling +24

ascender / capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

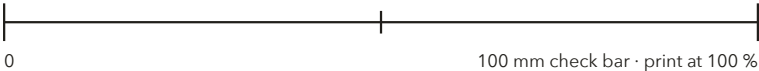
descender -10.5

flourish floor –18

Solid: baseline and x-height. Dashed: ascender and descender at $1.5 \times$ x-height. Dotted: flourish ceiling and floor. Faint diagonals: 55° slant. A row without printed words is a spare for a part-b continuation.

MUCH ADO ABOUT ONE SIDE • MASTER SHEET 5 OF 8

Rows R11b to R13a • write each row on the baseline beneath its printed words



R11b • Slit it lengthwise through:

R11b

Handwriting practice lines for row R11b. The row is defined by a solid baseline at 0. Above the baseline is a dashed line for ascenders and capitals at +10.5, and a dotted line for the flourish ceiling at +24. Below the baseline is a dashed line for descenders at -10.5, and a dotted line for the flourish floor at -18. Faint diagonal lines at a 55-degree angle are present across the row.

flourish ceiling +24
ascender • capitals +10.5
x-height +7
baseline 0
descender -10.5
flourish floor -18

R12 • it comes round doublelong, not two.

R12

Handwriting practice lines for row R12. The row is defined by a solid baseline at 0. Above the baseline is a dashed line for ascenders and capitals at +10.5, and a dotted line for the flourish ceiling at +24. Below the baseline is a dashed line for descenders at -10.5, and a dotted line for the flourish floor at -18. Faint diagonal lines at a 55-degree angle are present across the row.

flourish ceiling +24
ascender • capitals +10.5
x-height +7
baseline 0
descender -10.5
flourish floor -18

R13a • Then who's our foe?

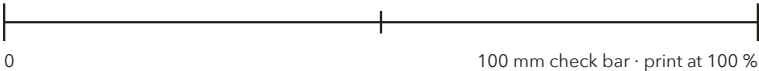
R13a

Handwriting practice lines for row R13a. The row is defined by a solid baseline at 0. Above the baseline is a dashed line for ascenders and capitals at +10.5, and a dotted line for the flourish ceiling at +24. Below the baseline is a dashed line for descenders at -10.5, and a dotted line for the flourish floor at -18. Faint diagonal lines at a 55-degree angle are present across the row.

flourish ceiling +24
ascender • capitals +10.5
x-height +7
baseline 0
descender -10.5
flourish floor -18

MUCH ADO ABOUT ONE SIDE • MASTER SHEET 6 OF 8

Rows R13b to R14b • write each row on the baseline beneath its printed words



R13b • Thy mirrorknave.

R13b

flourish ceiling +24
ascender • capitals +10.5
x-height +7
baseline 0
descender -10.5
flourish floor -18

R14a • Look edgewise:

R14a

flourish ceiling +24
ascender • capitals +10.5
x-height +7
baseline 0
descender -10.5
flourish floor -18

R14b • that's thine own swordwave.

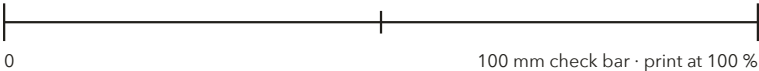
R14b

flourish ceiling +24
ascender • capitals +10.5
x-height +7
baseline 0
descender -10.5
flourish floor -18

Solid: baseline and x-height. Dashed: ascender and descender at 1.5 × x-height. Dotted: flourish ceiling and floor. Faint diagonals: 55° slant. A row without printed words is a spare for a part-b continuation.

MUCH ADO ABOUT ONE SIDE • MASTER SHEET 7 OF 8

Rows R15a to R16a · write each row on the baseline beneath its printed words



R15a · Onesided! End it!

R15a

Handwriting practice lines for row R15a. The row is defined by a solid baseline at 0. Above the baseline is a dashed line for ascenders and capitals at +10.5, and a dotted line for the flourish ceiling at +24. Below the baseline is a dashed line for descenders at -10.5, and a dotted line for the flourish floor at -18. Faint diagonal lines at a 55-degree angle are present across the row.

flourish ceiling +24
ascender · capitals +10.5
x-height +7
baseline 0
descender -10.5
flourish floor -18

R15b · The strip shrugs: Fine.

R15b

Handwriting practice lines for row R15b. The row is defined by a solid baseline at 0. Above the baseline is a dashed line for ascenders and capitals at +10.5, and a dotted line for the flourish ceiling at +24. Below the baseline is a dashed line for descenders at -10.5, and a dotted line for the flourish floor at -18. Faint diagonal lines at a 55-degree angle are present across the row.

flourish ceiling +24
ascender · capitals +10.5
x-height +7
baseline 0
descender -10.5
flourish floor -18

R16a · Tail dovetails head;

R16a

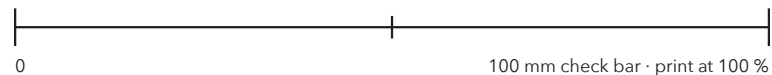
Handwriting practice lines for row R16a. The row is defined by a solid baseline at 0. Above the baseline is a dashed line for ascenders and capitals at +10.5, and a dotted line for the flourish ceiling at +24. Below the baseline is a dashed line for descenders at -10.5, and a dotted line for the flourish floor at -18. Faint diagonal lines at a 55-degree angle are present across the row.

flourish ceiling +24
ascender · capitals +10.5
x-height +7
baseline 0
descender -10.5
flourish floor -18

Solid: baseline and x-height. Dashed: ascender and descender at 1.5 × x-height. Dotted: flourish ceiling and floor. Faint diagonals: 55° slant. A row without printed words is a spare for a part-b continuation.

MUCH ADO ABOUT ONE SIDE • MASTER SHEET 8 OF 8

Rows R16b to R17 · write each row on the baseline beneath its printed words



R16b · mine's thine, thine's mine:

R16b

flourish ceiling +24

ascender / capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

descender -10.5

flourish floor -18

R17 · come, palindove, let edges twine...

R17

flourish ceiling +24

ascender / capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

descender -10.5

flourish floor -18

flourish ceiling +24

ascender / capitals +10.5

x-height +7

baseline 0

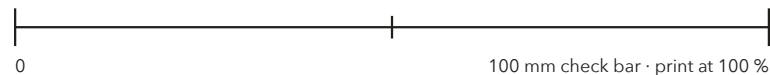
descender -10.5

flourish floor -18

Solid: baseline and x-height. Dashed: ascender and descender at $1.5 \times$ x-height. Dotted: flourish ceiling and floor. Faint diagonals: 55° slant. A row without printed words is a spare for a part-b continuation.

MUCH ADO ABOUT ONE SIDE • BLANK MASTER SHEET

Copperplate guide lines · x-height 7 mm suggested · write the row ID in the box



The diagram shows a 12-column grid with the following horizontal lines and labels on the right side:

- flourish ceiling +24 (dotted line)
- ascender / capitals +10,5 (dashed line)
- x-height +7 (solid line)
- baseline 0 (solid line)
- descender -10,5 (dashed line)
- flourish floor -18 (dotted line)

Vertical lines are solid in the first 6 columns and dashed in the last 6 columns. Diagonal lines are present in every column, and a small square is located in the first column.

The diagram shows a 12-column grid with the following horizontal lines and labels on the right side:

- flourish ceiling +24 (dotted line)
- ascender / capitals +10.5 (dashed line)
- x-height +7 (solid line)
- baseline 0 (solid line)
- descender -10.5 (dashed line)
- flourish floor -18 (dotted line)

Diagonal lines are drawn from the bottom-left to the top-right, passing through the grid at regular intervals.

The diagram illustrates a 12-line typographic grid. The lines are labeled on the right side as follows:

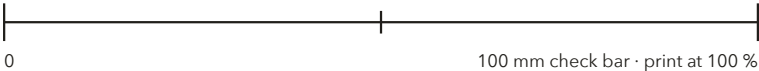
- flourish ceiling +24
- ascender / capitals +10.5
- x-height +7
- baseline 0
- descender -10.5
- flourish floor -18

On the left side, there is a small square box. The grid is composed of solid lines for the baseline and x-height, and dashed lines for the ascender and descender heights. Diagonal lines are drawn across the grid to represent the slant of the text.

Solid: baseline and x-height. Dashed: ascender and descender at $1.5 \times$ x-height. Dotted: flourish ceiling and floor. Faint diagonals: 55° slant. Use for rewrites and part-b rows.

MUCH ADO ABOUT ONE SIDE • PLAIN SHEET

Baseline and a faint x-height only · for writing without slant or loop lines · write the row ID in the box



x-height +7, if you want it

baseline

x-height +7, if you want it

baseline

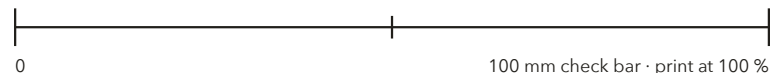
x-height +7, if you want it

baseline

Keep rows from touching each other; baselines are 56 mm apart for that. Everything else is your choice.

MUCH ADO ABOUT ONE SIDE • STYLE SAMPLE

Your alphabet in your own copperplate, at the size you will use for the poem. Also the reference for any digital repair.



Lowercase a to z, joined as you naturally join them

The diagram illustrates a 12-line typographic grid. The lines are labeled on the right side as follows:

- flourish ceiling +24
- ascender / capitals +10.5
- x-height +7
- baseline 0
- descender -10.5
- flourish floor -18

On the left side, there is a small square box. The grid is composed of solid lines for the baseline and x-height, and dashed lines for the ascender and descender heights. Diagonal lines are drawn across the grid to represent the slant of the text.

Capitals A to M with the flourishes you like best

The diagram illustrates a 10-line typographic grid. The lines are labeled on the right side as follows:

- flourish ceiling +24
- ascender / capitals +10.5
- x-height +7
- baseline 0
- descender -10.5
- flourish floor -18

On the left side, there is a small square box. The grid is composed of solid lines for the baseline and x-height, and dashed lines for the ascender and descender heights. Diagonal lines are drawn across the grid to represent the slant of the text.

Capitals N to Z with the flourishes you like best

The diagram illustrates a 10-line typographic grid. The lines are labeled on the right side as follows:

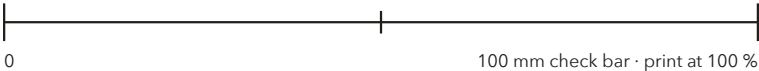
- flourish ceiling +24
- ascender / capitals +10.5
- x-height +7
- baseline 0
- descender -10.5
- flourish floor -18

The grid is composed of solid lines for the baseline and x-height, and dashed lines for the ascender and descender heights. The flourish ceiling and floor are indicated by dotted lines. The diagram also shows the relative positions of the lines for a capital letter 'A' and a lowercase letter 'a'.

Join the lowercase as you naturally would; give the capitals the flourishes you like best. Nothing here is compared with a font.

MUCH ADO ABOUT ONE SIDE · HARD WORDS

Invented and compound words, each written as one word with no gap or hyphen. Plain baselines; use your own slant.



palindove inkhands halfheight halfknight

x-height +7, if you want it

baseline

quarterknight knightling swordfeud

x-height +7, if you want it

baseline

inkprick's doublelong swordwave

x-height +7, if you want it

baseline

mirrorknave Onesided

x-height +7, if you want it

baseline

The easy parts

If you only read one page, read this one. The five essentials, the suggested sizes, the row checklist, and what to send back.

01

The exact words

Every letter and punctuation mark as printed on the exact-text page, one labelled row at a time, compound words unbroken.

02

Black on white

Dark black ink on smooth, bright white paper. Any pen you love, as long as its thinnest line is a solid line and not a scratch.

03

One row per label

Each row ID gets exactly one finished row. Never split a word between rows; if a row runs long, stop at a word gap and continue on the next row as part b.

04

Rows that stay apart

Flourish as freely as you like inside a row, but keep rows from touching each other. The sheets leave 56 mm between baselines for that.

05

A good scan

Flatbed, 1200 dpi if the scanner allows and 600 dpi otherwise, greyscale, no automatic enhancement, with the row labels and the 100 mm bar in frame.

GUIDE LINES ON THE SHEETS (SUGGESTED SIZES)

GUIDE LINE	ON YOUR PAPER (SUGGESTED)	ON THE 180 MM MAQUETTE
x-height (body of a, o, n)	7 mm · 6–10 mm is fine	0.89 mm
Ascender line (1.5 × x-height)	10.5 mm	1.34 mm
Descender line (1.5 × x-height)	10.5 mm	1.34 mm
Capitals	To the ascender line; flourishes may rise to the dotted ceiling	–
Flourish ceiling (above baseline)	24 mm	3.06 mm
Flourish floor (below baseline)	18 mm	2.30 mm
Baseline to baseline	56 mm	7.14 mm
Slant guide	55° from the baseline	unchanged
Gap between words	5–8 mm, or your usual	0.64 mm–1.02 mm
Thinnest line after adaptation	1 mm equivalent (we add this)	0.13 mm

Row checklist

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Wording matches the exact-text page, letter for letter | ☐ Compound words written as one word |
| ☐ Capitals only where the poem has them | ☐ No stroke touches the row above or below |
| ☐ Punctuation present and correct | ☐ Row ID written in the label box |

What to send

1. 23 approved rows across the sheets, plus the style-sample sheet, scanned as described, one file per sheet.
2. A line about the nib, ink, and paper you used, so the archive records the materials.
3. Any notes on rows you were unsure about, or flourishes you would like kept exactly as written.

Everything else is yours to decide

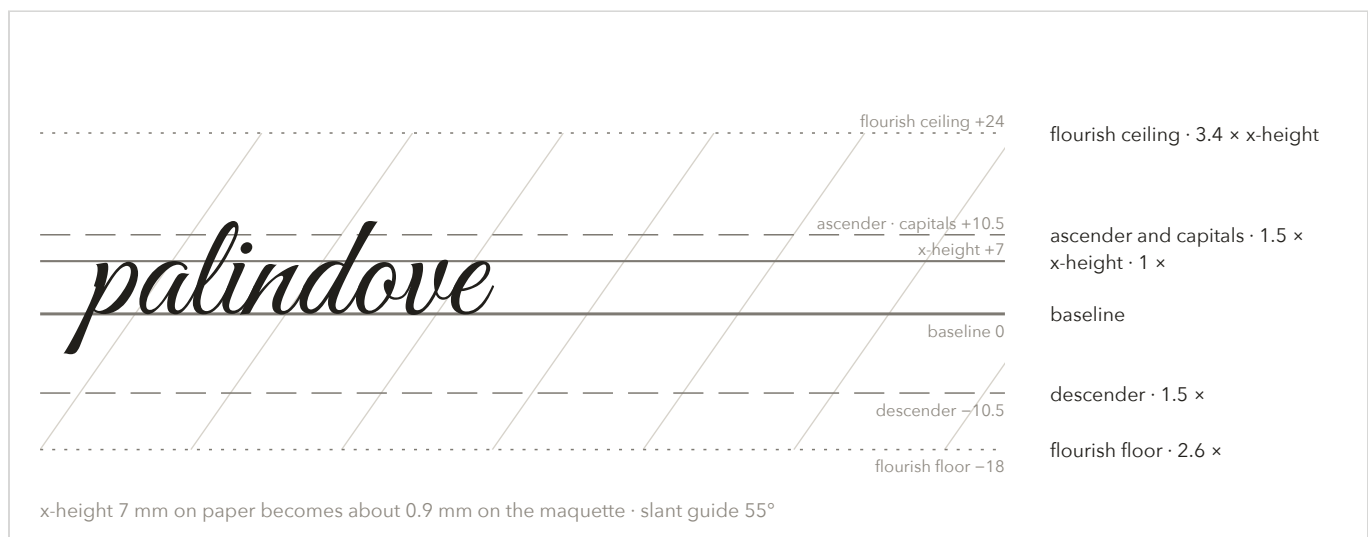
Size within the suggested range, slant, stroke contrast, the scale of your loops, how you join letters, where you lift the pen: none of it needs to match this guide. Write your best copperplate and let the adaptation meet you there.

In depth

Proportions, spacing and joins, flourish room, what the laser can hold and how the adaptation gets your hairlines there, materials in detail, the scan-to-foil pipeline, and troubleshooting.

Proportions

The guide-line set on every copperplate sheet, with the substitute font's "palindove" placed on it for scale only.



The sheets use the classic copperplate ratio of 2 : 3 : 3, so at a 7 mm x-height the ascender and descender lines sit 10.5 mm from the baseline. Capitals reach the ascender line and their flourishes may rise to the dotted ceiling 24 mm above the baseline; descender loops and lower flourishes may reach the floor 18 mm below. If your own proportions differ, keep yours: rows are normalised by x-height after the scan, and the ascender and descender lines are there to keep rows consistent with each other, not to change your letters.

Baselines are 56 mm apart, which leaves a clear gap between one row's floor and the next row's ceiling. On the sculpture the jaw master spaces rows 2.4 ems apart and the maquette's ribbon band is 10 mm tall for a 2.5 mm em, both roomy enough for the dotted limits. The large body master currently stacks 4 rows only 1.4 ems apart; before that run Andrew re-spaces the body rows to the real extent of your capitals and descenders, so do not tighten your hand for it.

Spacing, joins, and slant

- Join letters as you normally do and lift where you normally lift. The adaptation keeps your joins; it never redraws them.
- Words are separated by your usual gap, about 5–8 mm at this size. The gap between poem lines on the ribbon is doubled (10–16 mm); Andrew adds that when the rows are joined, so end each row after its final punctuation with no special gap.
- The slant guide is 55° from the baseline, the copperplate standard. Use your own angle and keep it steady; it is not adjusted afterwards.
- The ribbon is one continuous line, so the tail of each row meets the head of the next at a word gap. Exit strokes may trail and an entry flourish may lead in; neither needs to be shorter than you would normally make it.
- The final ellipsis runs into the first word. Give the three dots a normal ending and let the first “C” carry whatever lead-in flourish you like; the join will read as a loop either way.

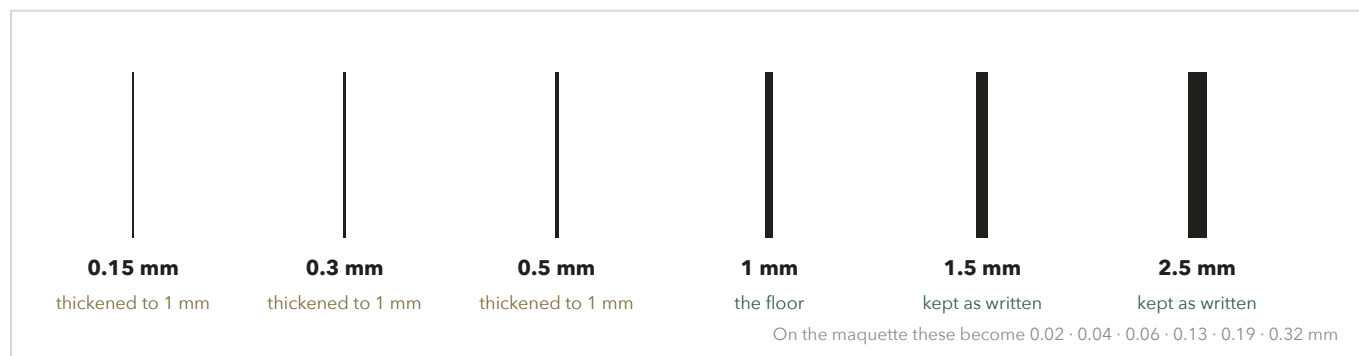
Capitals and flourishes

The poem uses these capitals: C, D, E, F, I, L, O, S, T. Each begins a line or a sentence except the lowercase “come” that starts the last line, which is deliberate: the poem loops, so its last line is a continuation. Flourished capitals are wanted. Keep a flourish clear of the letters of other words so it stays readable at 2.5 mm, and keep it inside the dotted lines; a flourish that crosses the ceiling or floor is the one thing the adaptation may have to trim, and you would see that on the proof.

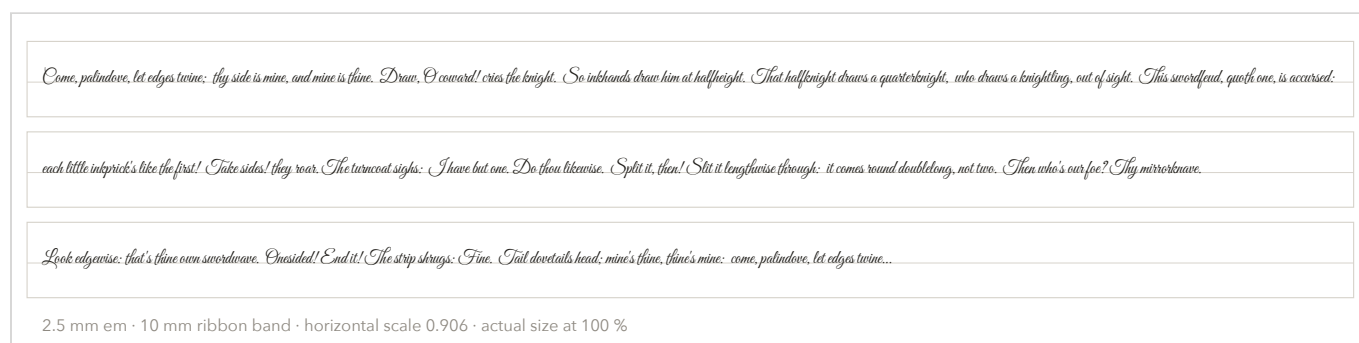
Hairlines, shades, and the laser

The foil is 0.127 mm AlumaMark aluminum. A CO₂ laser darkens its coating rather than cutting it, and the marked line cannot be narrower than the beam's focused spot, roughly 0.1–0.2 mm. Your master is scaled by 0.128 to reach the maquette's 2.5 mm em, so a copperplate hairline of 0.1 mm on paper would become 0.013 mm on the foil and vanish. That is why the adaptation thickens every hairline to at least 1 mm at working scale, 0.13 mm on the foil, before scaling. Shaded downstrokes are already well above that floor and keep their exact width. The result reads as a slightly bolder copperplate, with your contrast softened but your forms intact.

For reference only: the thinnest line the adaptation leaves is the 1 mm bar; a scanner still needs your pen's hairline to be a solid line of about 0.15 mm or more.



The substitute font at maquette size (2.5 mm em), actual size when printed at 100 %: this is how small the ribbon is on the 180 mm form.



What the adaptation does, and does not do

- Does: trace the scans into closed vector outlines at hairline resolution; thicken hairlines to the floor above; normalise rows to one x-height; even out word gaps; join the rows into the ribbon; trim or re-space a flourish that would collide on the sculpture; repair a broken hairline or remove a blot using your own strokes as the pattern.
- May, with your agreement on the proof: unify a letter that varies noticeably between rows by choosing one of your own versions; adjust the overall weight for a specific edition.
- Does not: invent letters, change joins, alter slant, redraw flourishes, or substitute anything from a font. Where a repair is impossible from your strokes, the row comes back to you to rewrite.

Materials in detail

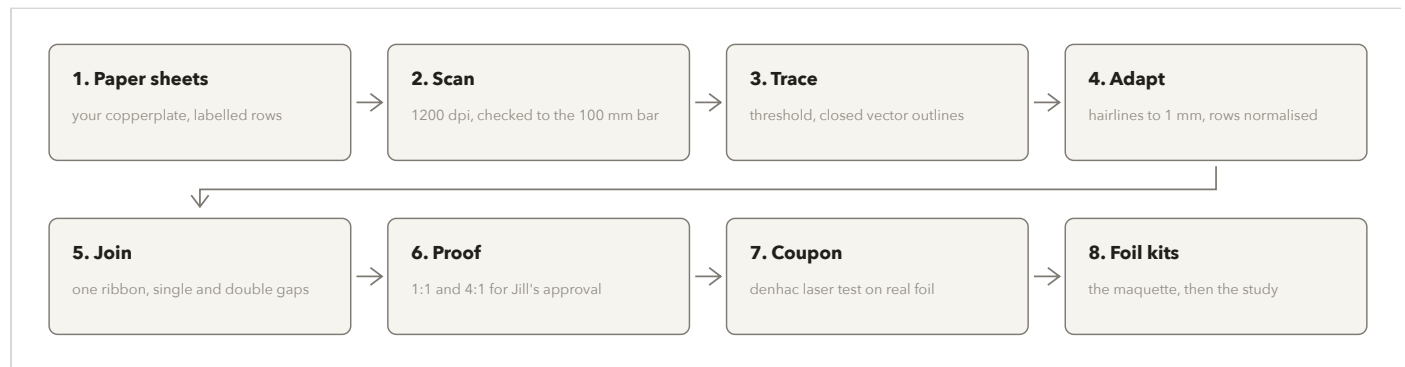
ITEM	YOUR USUAL, OR	ALSO FINE	AVOID
Nib and holder	Whatever you write copperplate with now. Common choices: Nikko G or Zebra G for a firm, forgiving point; Leonardt Principal EF or Hunt 101 for finer hairlines and deeper shades. An oblique holder with the flange set for your nib.	A straight holder if that is your habit; a pointed brush pen if you sometimes letter that way.	A change of nib for this job. Familiar tools give the most beautiful, most consistent rows.
Ink	Dense black: Moon Palace or Kuretake sumi, McCaffery's Penman's black, Ziller Soot Black, Higgins Eternal.	A drop of gum arabic in sumi if hairlines skip; distilled water to thin if it drags.	Walnut, sepia, iron gall, blue-black, coloured or metallic inks, gel or ballpoint pens: they scan grey or shiny and lose the hairlines.
Paper	Rhodia or Clairefontaine Triomphe 90 g pads, the usual copperplate papers: smooth, no feathering, thin enough to see guide lines through.	HP Premium Choice 32 lb or Clairefontaine 120 g if you print the sheets straight onto the writing paper; Strathmore 400 smooth Bristol with a light pad.	Textured, cotton, cream, or toned paper, and thin copier paper that feathers.
Guide lines	Print the master sheets on plain paper and lay your writing paper over them on a light pad or a bright window, taped with low-tack tape.	Print the sheets directly onto laser-safe writing paper. Or rule your own baselines in pencil and copy the row IDs into the margin.	Ink guide lines on the master; pencil lines are fine if erased gently after the ink is dry.
Prep and tools	Nib prepared as you usually do, ink in a dinky dip or small jar, water, tissue, scrap of the same paper, 2H pencil, soft eraser, low-tack tape.	A slant card cut from a template, a light pad.	Correction fluid or white gouache on a master row: rewrite the row instead.
Capture	Flatbed scan at 1200 dpi greyscale, no auto-enhance or sharpening, TIFF or PNG, whole sheet in frame.	600 dpi if 1200 is unavailable; a phone photo in even daylight, straight on, whole sheet in frame, only as a stopgap.	JPEG at low quality, cropped scans that lose the labels or bar, skewed or shadowed photos.

Dense black on smooth bright white scans as a clean two-tone image, which is what vector tracing needs, and 1200 dpi keeps a 0.1 mm hairline about five pixels wide so it traces as a line rather than a chain of dots.

Glossy inks reflect the scanner lamp and speckle the shades; textured paper adds noise along every edge; cream paper lowers contrast. Rhodia and Clairefontaine stay flat on the scanner glass.

From scan to foil

What happens to the sheets after they are scanned.



1. Each scan is checked against its 100 mm bar and straightened using the printed baselines.
2. The image is thresholded to pure black and white and traced into closed vector outlines.
3. Hairlines are thickened to 1 mm at working scale; shades are left as written.
4. Each row is measured from its baseline and x-height lines and normalised to the 19.6 mm em, so rows written on different days still match.
5. Rows are joined in poem order with even word gaps inside a line and a double gap between lines, producing one continuous ribbon.
6. The ribbon's length is compared with the current layout (about 194 ems for one poem). Differences are absorbed by word gaps and a small uniform scale; a copperplate hand is usually wider than the placeholder, and that is expected.
7. The ribbon replaces the font outlines in the generators for both editions: two repetitions around the maquette's 1028 mm body circuit, and one poem per row on the large study.
8. You receive a proof. After approval, denhac staff mark a small test coupon with your lettering at 2.5, 4, 6, 8, 10 and 14 mm em sizes on the actual foil, and we look at it together before any full sheet is marked.

Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	LIKELY CAUSE	FIX
Hairlines skip or break	Nib not fully prepared, ink too thick, or paper too absorbent	Re-prepare the nib, add a drop of gum arabic or water to the ink, or move to Rhodia or Clairefontaine.
Edges feather or bleed	Absorbent or textured paper, or a very wet line	Switch to smooth pad paper; let a wet shade dry before the next row.
Ink pools or blots at joins	Pausing with the nib on the paper, or too much ink on the nib	Lift between words; wipe the nib more often.
x-height drifts along the row	Long rows, or the guide sheet slipping	Tape the guide sheet and paper together; write in shorter bursts; rewrite the row if it drifts more than a millimetre.
Slant wanders	Paper rotated on the light pad	Square the paper to the guide sheet's slant lines before each row.
Row runs out of room	A wide hand or generous flourishes	Stop at a word gap and continue on the next row as part b; never squeeze the last word.
Two rows touch	A tall flourish or a deep loop	Rewrite the lower or upper row; or write the poem with an extra blank row between rows if your loops need it.
Scan looks grey or speckled	Auto-enhance, glossy ink, or low resolution	Rescan at 1200 dpi greyscale with all automatic corrections off.

Punctuation inventory

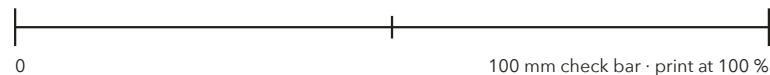
MARK	NAME	COUNT
,	comma	13
;	semicolon	2
:	colon	6
!	exclamation mark	6
?	question mark	1
.	full stop	11
'	apostrophe	5
...	ellipsis (one character, three dots)	1

The apostrophes belong to inkprick's, who's, that's, mine's and thine's. The only ellipsis is the last character of the poem. There are no quotation marks, dashes, or parentheses anywhere.

The placeholder the site shows today

MUCH ADO ABOUT ONE SIDE • PLACEHOLDER COMPARISON

Rows R01 to R03 in the substitute font Great Vibes on the copperplate sheet lines. A size comparison only.



R01 *Come, palindove, let edges twine;*

flourish ceiling +24
ascender · capitals +10.5
x-height +7
baseline 0
descender -10.5
flourish floor -18

R02 *thy side is mine, and mine is thine.*

flourish ceiling +24
ascender · capitals +10.5
x-height +7
baseline 0
descender -10.5
flourish floor -18

R03 *Draw, O coward! cries the knight.*

flourish ceiling +24
ascender · capitals +10.5
x-height +7
baseline 0
descender -10.5
flourish floor -18

